Staff Training Walkthrough: Using AI Safely at Maple & Birch

About 20 minutes · read on your own or together at a team meeting · finish with the quiz and sign-off
Maple & Birch Bookkeeping (SAMPLE) · Policy version 1.0

> **SAMPLE: fictional office.** "Maple & Birch Bookkeeping" is made up to show what a Clear Rules client document looks like. This is general guidance, not legal advice. Clear Rules Cyber Security makes no promise of compliance with any law, insurance result, or security outcome.

Part 1: Why this matters (3 min)

We hold the information that lets someone steal a client's identity or money: SINs, bank accounts, CRA access. AI chatbots are useful, but what you paste in can be stored by the vendor, reviewed by its staff, or exposed in a breach. Our clients trust us with this, and Alberta's privacy law (PIPA) expects us to protect it with reasonable security.

Part 2: The two tools we use (3 min)

- **Microsoft 365 Copilot**, signed in with your work account. It can read files *you* can open, so if a folder is shared too widely, Copilot can surface it. Tell the Policy Owner if Copilot shows you something you shouldn't see.
- **ChatGPT Team**, our company workspace, for the owner and senior bookkeeper.
- **Nothing else for work**, and especially not your personal ChatGPT or a free website.

Part 3: The colours (5 min)

GREEN = public. AMBER = internal, but no names. RED = anything that identifies a client or staff member. NEVER = passwords and logins.

Try it. Which colour is each? 1. "Summarize CRA's rules for home-office expenses." → GREEN 2. Pasting our internal month-end checklist to tidy the wording. → AMBER 3. Uploading Mrs. K's T4 to ask what box 14 means. → RED: don't. Ask the question without the slip. 4. Asking ChatGPT to remember the client portal password. → NEVER

Trick: strip it, then ask. "A client earned $X employment income and $Y rental income…" works just as well as uploading the slip.

Part 4: Check before it leaves (3 min)

AI invents numbers, rules, and deadlines that sound right. Before anything goes to a client, CRA, or a bank, check every number and rule against the source. A second AI answer doesn't count as a check.

Part 5: The money rule (3 min)

Scammers now use AI to copy voices and write perfect emails. **Never** change banking details or send money because of an email, text, or call alone, even if it sounds like the owner or a client you know. Hang up and call back on the number on file.

Part 6: When something goes wrong (3 min)

Pasted the wrong thing? Got a weird call? Tell the Policy Owner **today** with the Report-a-Concern Form. Speed matters: some incidents must be reported to the Privacy Commissioner, and we can only do that if we know. Honest, prompt reports aren't punished.

Quiz (5 questions, answers below)

1. Which accounts may you use for work AI? (a) any (b) only company accounts on the Register (c) personal if it's faster
2. A client's SIN is which colour? (a) AMBER (b) RED (c) GREEN
3. Copilot gave you a tax deadline. Before you send it to a client you… (a) send it (b) check it against the CRA source (c) ask ChatGPT to confirm
4. "The owner" calls asking you to pay a new vendor today. You… (a) pay (b) call back on the number on file (c) email to confirm
5. You pasted a client's bank statement into a free chatbot. You… (a) delete it and say nothing (b) tell the Policy Owner today (c) wait and see

Answers: 1b, 2b, 3b, 4b, 5b. Record your score on the Acknowledgement form.